

a balance**Bb**

VERB balances, balancing, balanced

1 When you balance, you keep your body steady and don't fall over. *Can you **balance** on one leg?*

NOUN

2 If you have good balance, you can keep your body steady and not fall.

balcony

NOUN balconies

A balcony is a small platform outside an upstairs window of a building, where you can sit.

bald

ADJECTIVE

Someone who is bald has no hair.

ball

NOUN balls

1 A ball is a round object that you use to play games and sports.

2 A ball is a big, grand party where there is dancing.

ballet

NOUN

Ballet is a type of dancing in which you dance on the ends of your toes and move very gracefully.

balloon

NOUN balloons

A balloon is a bag of very thin rubber that you can fill with air or other gases.

ban

VERB bans, banning, banned

If people ban something, they say that you are not allowed to do it. *The teachers have **banned** soccer in the playground.*

banana

NOUN bananas

A banana is a long, thin fruit with a yellow skin that you peel off.

band

NOUN bands

1 A band is a group of people who play music together.

2 A band is a narrow strip or circle of something. *The team captain usually wears a special arm **band**.*

bandage

NOUN bandages

A bandage is a strip of material that you wrap around a wound to keep it clean.

bang

NOUN bangs

1 A bang is a sudden loud noise. *The firework went off with a loud **bang**.*

VERB bangs, banging, banged

2 When something bangs, it makes a loud noise.

3 When you bang on something, you hit it hard. *We **banged** on the door.*

bank

NOUN banks

1 The bank of a river is the ground along the edge of it.

2 A bank is a place where people can put their money to keep it safe. People can also borrow money from a bank.

bar

NOUN bars

1 A bar is a long, narrow piece of metal. *There were **bars** on all the windows.*

2 A large, usually rectangular piece of chocolate is called a bar of chocolate. *I ate half a **bar** of chocolate on Saturday.*

3 A bar is a place where people can buy drinks.

barbecue

NOUN barbecues

1 A barbecue is a grill that you use to cook food outside.

2 A meal that you cook outside in this way is also called a barbecue. *We're having a **barbecue** tonight.*

bar chart

NOUN bar charts

A bar chart is a graph on which bars of different lengths show the different amounts of things. *The **bar chart** shows the favorite colors chosen by the pupils in my class.*

barcode

NOUN barcodes

A barcode is a pattern of thick and thin lines that is printed on things you buy in stores. The barcode contains information about the things.

barbecue